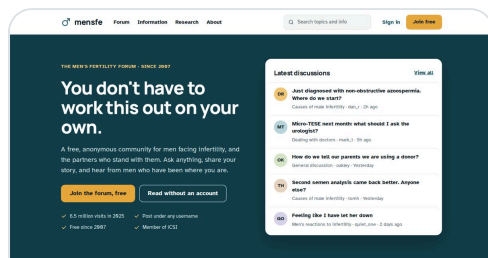


Four directions for the Mensfe forum

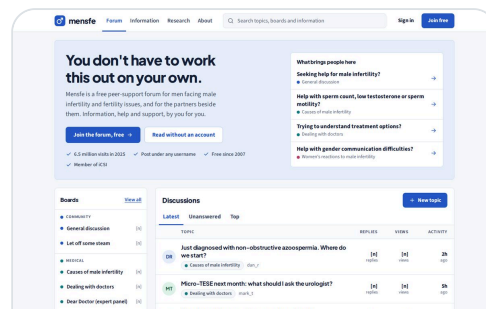
Each direction redesigns the same forum around the same content: a forum-first homepage, the board index, a topic page and a medical information page, all mobile-ready and built to fix the issues in the SEO audit.

Directions A–C present the forum through a modern website front; Direction D keeps the look and feel of a true message board. Please pick one direction (or the parts you like from each) and we will develop it into the full site and SMF theme.



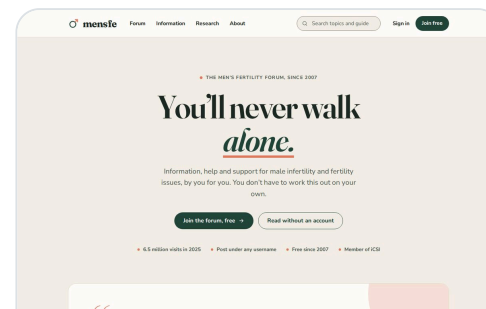
A • Harbour

Bold and branded. Confident, recognisable, a little dramatic.



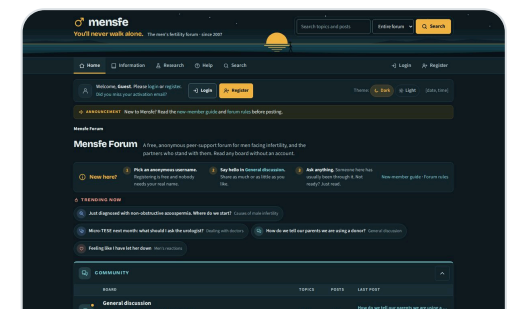
B • Clear

Clean and clinical. Feels like a modern health service crossed with a forum app.



C • Stories

Warm and human. Leads with members' voices, like a thoughtful magazine.

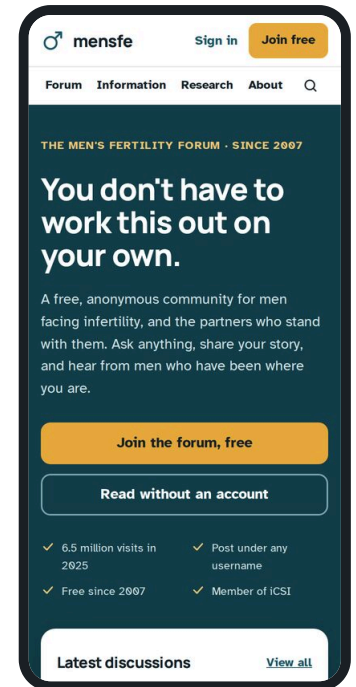
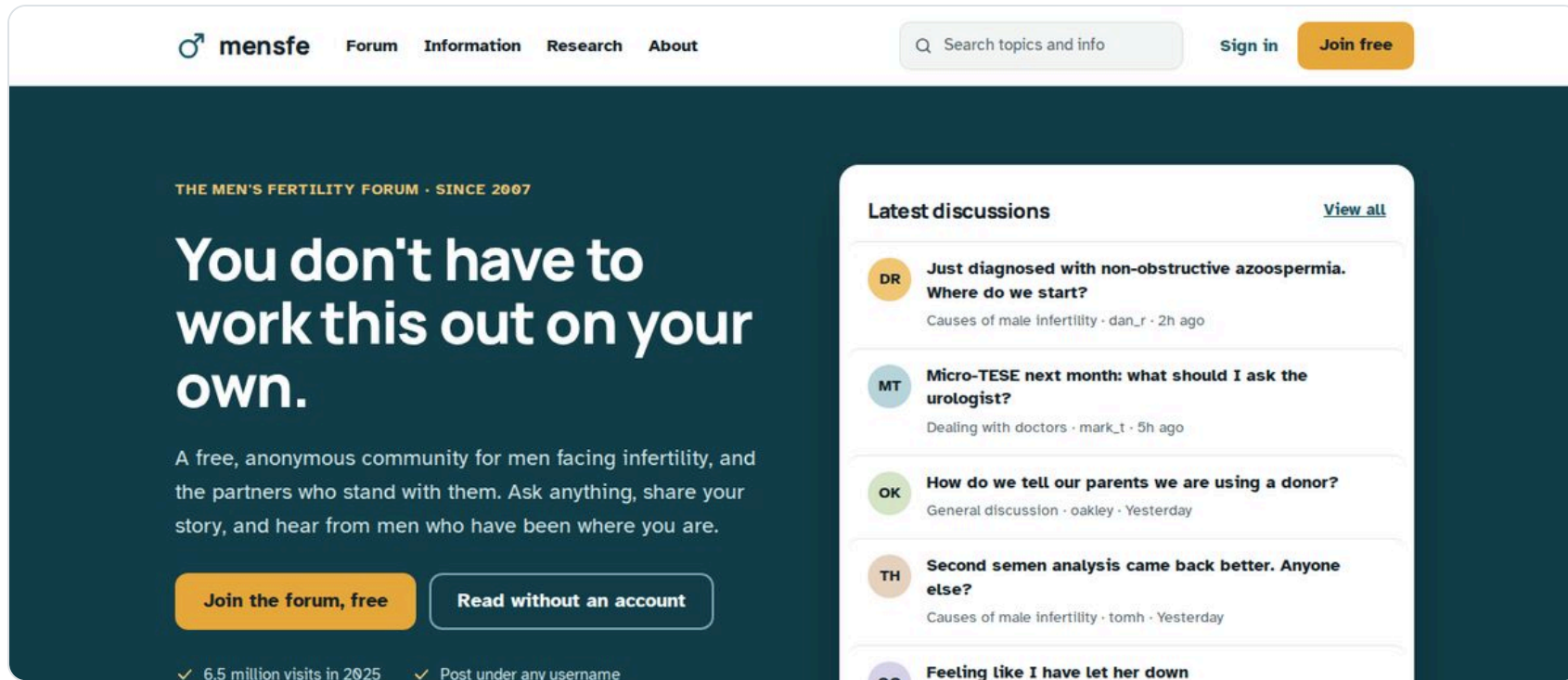


D • Forum

A true message board. Dark, distinctive and built around the board index.

All three share the same fixes: one clear heading per page, real text instead of text in images, latest discussions on the homepage, the founders' credentials on show, reviewer and date on medical pages, accessible contrast, and layouts that work on phones. Member counts appear as [n] placeholders, and sample posts are illustrative.

Harbour: bold and branded



Personality

- The deep sea-teal of the current shoreline banner, with a sunset-gold call to action
- A strong, memorable hero; the forum is visible from the first screen
- Best if Mensfe wants to look established and confident

Colour and type

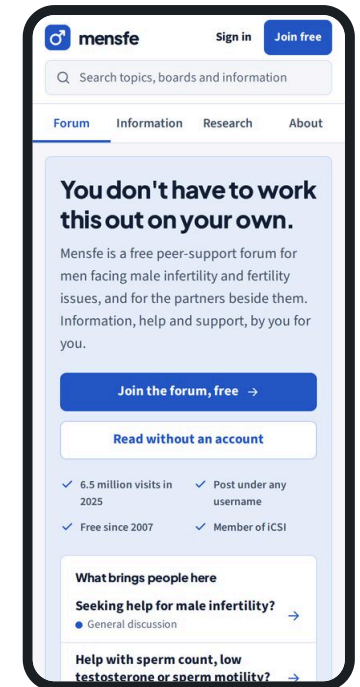
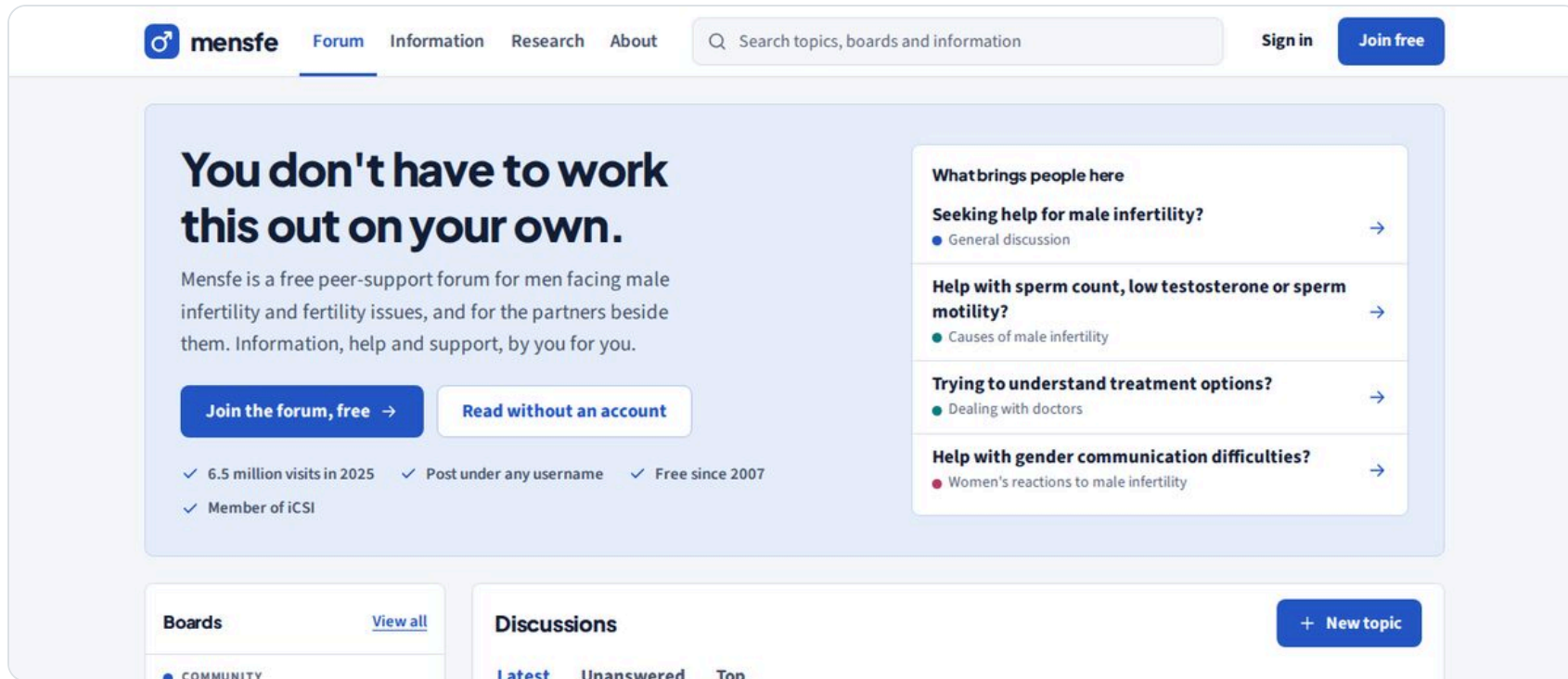


- Manrope headings, Atkinson Hyperlegible body text (designed for low-vision readability)

Watch-outs

- Dark bands are heavier on long pages
- Gold needs disciplined use to stay special

Clear: clean and clinical



Personality

- Calm, trustworthy and information-dense, like a modern health service
- A forum "app" layout: boards in a sidebar, a live topic feed with Latest, Unanswered and Top
- Best if Mensfe wants to feel medically credible and efficient

Colour and type

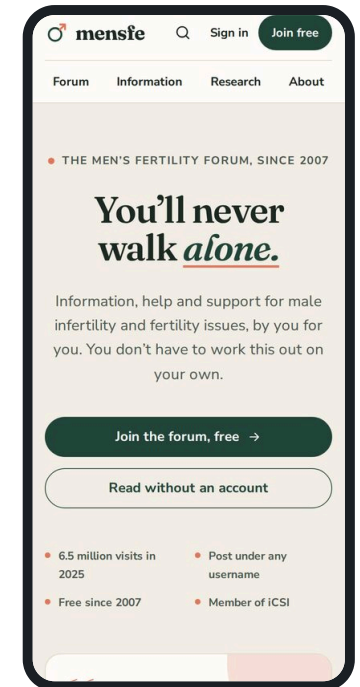
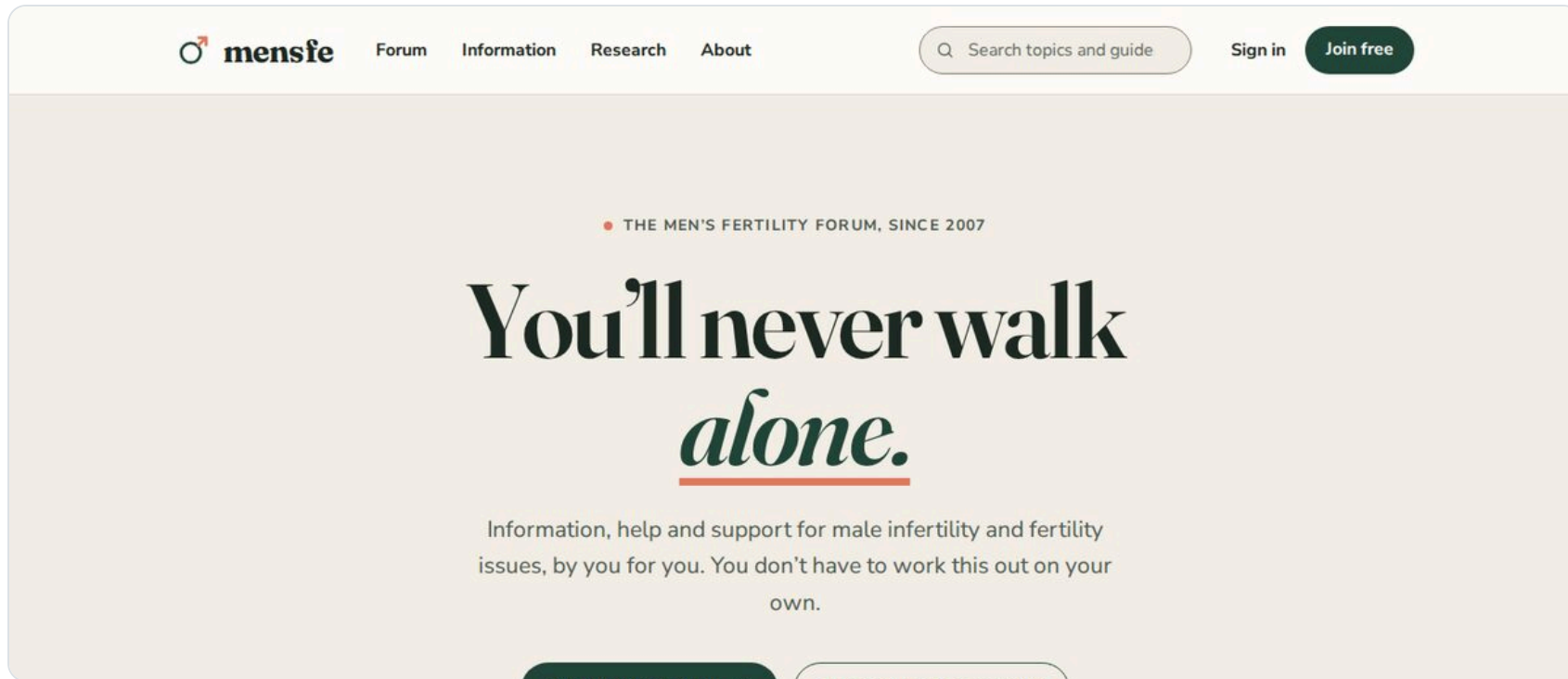


- Plus Jakarta Sans headings, Source Sans 3 body text

Watch-outs

- Can feel less personal; relies on activity in the feed
- Closest to SMF's own structure, so the easiest to theme

Stories: warm and human



Personality

- Editorial and reassuring; members' own words take centre stage
- Generous spacing and a serif voice for a reflective, magazine feel
- Best if Mensfe wants to emphasise empathy and the emotional side

Colour and type



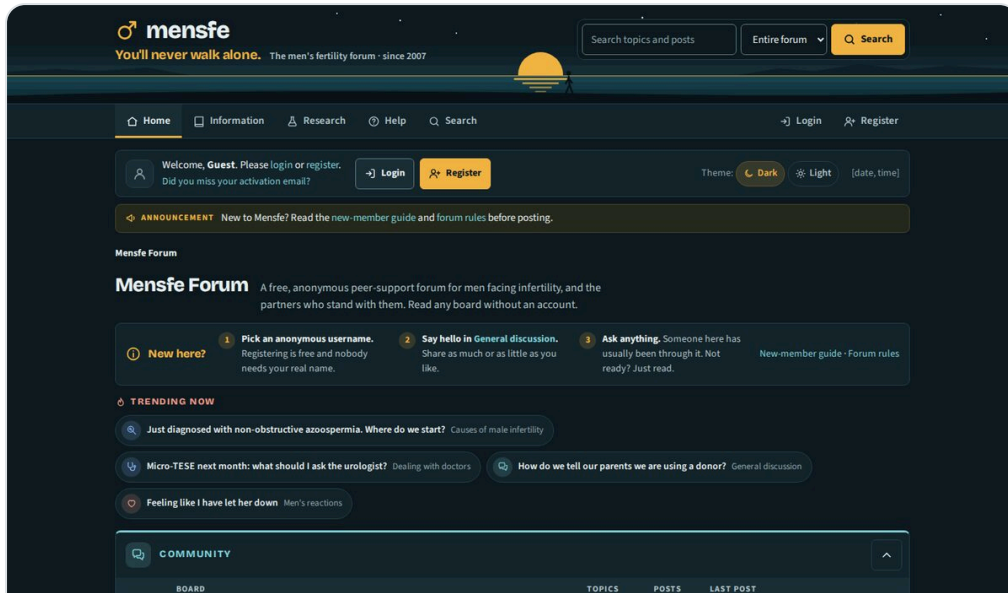
- Fraunces headings, Nunito Sans body text

Watch-outs

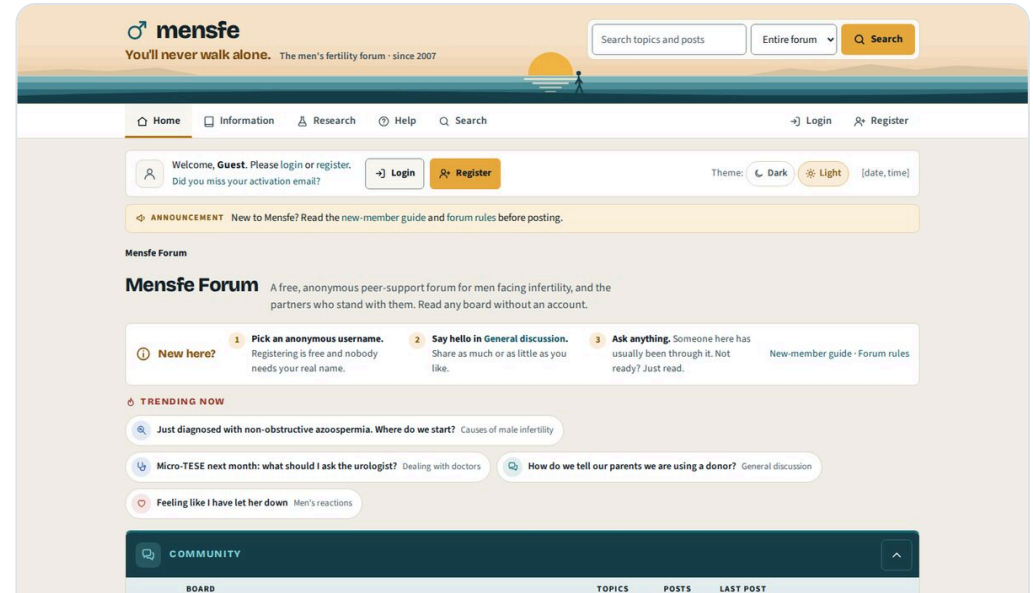
- Needs members' consent for featured stories
- Less dense, so more scrolling on busy boards

DIRECTION D

Forum: a true message board, reimagined



Dark · Midnight shoreline



Light · Daybreak shoreline

Personality

- The board index is the homepage, so regulars land straight in the forum
- Classic forum anatomy (category bars, last-post columns, profile panels beside posts, quick reply, info center) with a modern dark finish
- An illustrated night-shoreline banner revives "You'll never walk alone at Mensfe"

Colour and type



- Bricolage Grotesque headings, Source Sans 3 body text; each category has its own colour

Watch-outs

- Comes in dark and light; SMF can offer both as a member setting
- Closest to SMF's own templates, so it is the quickest to build

How the directions compare

	A · HARBOUR	B · CLEAR	C · STORIES	D · FORUM
First impression	Confident, branded	Professional, efficient	Warm, empathetic	Distinctive, community-first
Forum emphasis	Latest-discussions card in the hero; board grid	Live topic feed is the homepage	Featured member stories, then boards	The whole site is the forum; board index is home
Medical credibility	Good	Strongest	Good, more personal	Good (information section inside the forum)
Emotional warmth	Medium	Lower	Highest	Medium–high (members' voices up front)
Effort to theme SMF	Medium	Low	Medium–high	Lowest
Accessibility	Very high (hyperlegible body font)	High	High	High (contrast checked for dark mode)

What happens next: once a direction is chosen, we design the remaining pages (sign-up, profile, search, private messages and the 12 information guides), build the responsive SMF theme, and implement the SEO and AI visibility fixes from the audits during the same build.

THE MEN'S FERTILITY FORUM · SINCE 2007

You don't have to work this out on your own.

A free, anonymous community for men facing infertility, and the partners who stand with them. Ask anything, share your story, and hear from men who have been where you are.

Join the forum, free

Read without an account

-  6.5 million visits in 2025
-  Post under any username
-  Free since 2007
-  Member of iCSI

Latest discussions

[View all](#)

- DR

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

Causes of male infertility · dan_r · 2h ago
- MT

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist?

Dealing with doctors · mark_t · 5h ago
- OK

How do we tell our parents we are using a donor?

General discussion · oakley · Yesterday
- TH

Second semen analysis came back better. Anyone else?

Causes of male infertility · tomh · Yesterday
- GO

Feeling like I have let her down

Men's reactions to infertility · quiet_one · 2 days ago

Whatever brought you here

Someone on the forum has asked the same question. Start where you are.

Seeking help for male infertility?

 General discussion

Trying to increase sperm count, motility or low testosterone?

 Causes of male infertility

Trying to understand treatment options?

 Dealing with doctors

Finding it hard to talk about it as a couple?

 Women's reactions to male infertility

Find your board

Every stage of the journey has a place. Read freely; join to post.

[All boards](#) →



COMMUNITY

General discussion

Anything and everything about male fertility.

[n] topics · [n] posts



COMMUNITY

Let off some steam

Somewhere to vent when it all gets too much.

[n] topics · [n] posts



MEDICAL

Causes of male infertility

Azoospermia, low count, varicocele, hormones and more.

[n] topics · [n] posts



MEDICAL

Dealing with doctors

Appointments, clinics, tests and treatment.

[n] topics · [n] posts



MEDICAL

Dear Doctor (expert panel)

Questions answered by our medical panel.

[n] topics · [n] posts



FEELINGS AND RELATIONSHIPS

Men's reactions to infertility

How it feels, from the men living it.

[n] topics · [n] posts



FEELINGS AND RELATIONSHIPS

Women's reactions to male infertility

Partners share their side.

[n] topics · [n] posts



RESEARCH

Current research on male infertility

New studies, trials and news.

[n] topics · [n] posts

New here? Start in three steps

- 1

Pick an anonymous username.

No real name needed. Your email stays private.
- 2

Say hello in General discussion.

Share as much or as little as you want.
- 3

Ask anything.

There are no stupid questions here. Someone has asked it before.

Create your free account

Understand the medical terms

Plain-English guides to the tests, conditions and treatments you'll hear about, each linked to the board where men discuss it. Our information resources are free for everyone.

Male fertility

Infertility

Semen analysis

Azoospermia

Varicocele

Treatment

Vasectomy reversal

Erection problems

Egg donation

Sperm donation

Nutrition

Counselling support

Also: [Medical guide: jargon explained](#) [Emotive guide: the emotional side](#)

RESEARCH BOARD

Current research on male infertility

Members share and discuss new studies, clinical trials and news, so you can bring better questions to your next appointment.

[Browse the research board](#)

Latest: New study on sperm DNA fragmentation testing

WHO RUNS MENSFE

Started by people who have lived it

Mensfe is an independent peer-support community, and a member of iCSI (International Consumer Support for Infertility).

[About us and our mission](#) →

PR

Pip Reilly

Co-founder · Fertility counsellor

A professional fertility counsellor with over 15 years' experience with fertility charities, and author of *A Journey Through Male Infertility*.

RB

Rob Barlow

Co-founder · Medical scientist

A medical scientist who was diagnosed with azoospermia more than 25 years ago, and knows first-hand what the first weeks after a diagnosis feel like.

A JOURNEY THROUGH MALE INFERTILITY

STRONGER TOGETHER

PIP REILLY

THE MENSFE BOOK

A Journey Through Male Infertility: a book for men that women should read

An honest, accessible account by Pip Reilly of the relational, emotional and physical challenges men face, often unspoken, with practical support strategies. You are stronger together.

[View on Amazon](#) 

[Home](#) > [Forum](#)

The Mensfe forum

Peer support for men facing infertility, and the partners who stand with them. Read any board without an account; join free to post under any username.

 Search topics, e.g. micro-TESE

Search

+ Start a new topic

[n] members · [n] topics · [n] posts

 Community

2 boards



General discussion
Anything and everything about male fertility.

[n] topics
[n] posts

OA

Last post

How do we tell our parents we are using a donor?

oakley · Yesterday



Let off some steam
Somewhere to vent when it all gets too much.

[n] topics
[n] posts

BI

Last post

Another pregnancy announcement at work today

big_al · 3h ago

 Medical

3 boards



Causes of male infertility
Azoospermia, low count, varicocele, hormones and more.

[n] topics
[n] posts

DA

Last post

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

dan_r · 2h ago



Dealing with doctors
Appointments, clinics, tests and treatment.

[n] topics
[n] posts

MA

Last post

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist?

mark_t · 5h ago



Dear Doctor (expert panel)
Questions answered by our medical panel.

[n] topics
[n] posts

BE

Last post

Is it worth repairing a varicocele before ICSI?

ben_w · 2 days ago

 Feelings and relationships

2 boards



Men's reactions to infertility
How it feels, from the men living it.

[n] topics
[n] posts

QU

Last post

Feeling Like I have let her down

quiet_one · 2 days ago



Women's reactions to male infertility
Partners share their side.

[n] topics
[n] posts

SA

Last post

How do I support him without making it worse?

sarah_m · 8h ago

 Research

1 board



Current research on male infertility
New studies, trials and news.

[n] topics
[n] posts

RE

Last post

New study on sperm DNA fragmentation testing

researchreader · Yesterday

Who's online

[n] members and [n] guests

Recently active: dan_r, mark_t, oakley, sarah_m and others posting under usernames.

Forum rules

1. **Be kind.** Everyone here is going through something hard.

2. **Protect your privacy.** Keep real names and clinics out of posts if you prefer.

3. **Share experience, not diagnoses.**
This is peer support, not medical advice.

4. **No selling or advertising.**

[Read the full rules](#) →

New-member guide

1 Pick an anonymous username.

2 Say hello in General discussion.

3 Ask anything. Someone has been there.

[Join free](#)

 **Peer support, not medical advice.** For questions about your own results, the Dear Doctor board and our [information guides](#) are a good place to start.

[Forum](#) > [Causes of male infertility](#) > [Topic](#)

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

 Started by dan_r  2h ago  [n] replies  [n] following

 Reply

 Follow

 Share

Showing all [n] posts

Page 1 of 1

 DR

dan_r

Member

Original poster

Joined [date] · [n] posts · Posted 2h ago

My wife and I got the results last week. Two semen analyses, both showed no sperm at all, and the consultant thinks it is probably non-obstructive. My FSH came back high.

I honestly don't know what to feel. I keep reading about micro-TESE and success rates and it is all a blur. If anyone has been through this, what should we be asking at the next appointment?

 Helpful [n]

 Support [n]

 Quote

 Reply

 MT

mark_t

Member

Joined [date] · [n] posts · Posted 1h ago

I was exactly where you are three years ago. Write your questions down before the appointment, because you will forget them in the room. Ask whether they have checked your karyotype and for Y-chromosome microdeletions, because that changed what our options were.

And look after yourself. The first month was the hardest part for me.

 Helpful [n]

 Support [n]

 Quote

 Reply

 MF

Mensfe Team

Moderator

Joined [date] · [n] posts · Posted 48 min ago

Welcome, and thank you for posting. A lot of men read this board without ever writing, so this will help others too. Our [Azoospermia guide](#) explains the tests and treatment terms you will hear, and the [Counselling Support](#) page lists services if you would like to talk to someone.

 Helpful [n]

 Support [n]

 Quote

 Reply

 JO

jo_partner

Partner

Joined [date] · [n] posts · Posted 20 min ago

Wife of a member here. It is not your fault, and she is probably as worried about you as about the result. Talking to each other helped us more than anything the clinic said.

 Helpful [n]

 Support [n]

 Quote

 Reply

Reply to this topic

You're posting as your forum username. Share your experience; please don't diagnose.

Your reply

B

I





Write something supportive, or share what helped you.

☒ Notify me of replies

Post reply

Topic info

Board	Causes of male infertility
Started	2h ago
Replies	[n]
Following	[n]

Related information

[Azoospermia explained](#)

[Surgical sperm retrieval](#)

[Counselling support](#)



This is peer support, not medical advice. Members share their own experience. Talk to your doctor about your own results and options.

Similar topics

High FSH and no sperm: what did your urologist suggest?

Causes of male infertility · [n] replies

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist?

Dealing with doctors · [n] replies

Karyotype normal, still waiting on Y-microdeletion results

Causes of male infertility · [n] replies

Feeling like I have let her down

Men's reactions to infertility · [n] replies

Azoospermia

What it means when a semen analysis finds no sperm, the two main types, how it is diagnosed and the treatment routes to parenthood.

 Written by **[Author name]**  Medically reviewed by **[Reviewer name, credentials]**  Last reviewed **[date]**

Mensfe is run by **Pip Reilly**, a professional fertility counsellor, and **Rob Barlow**, a medical scientist who was diagnosed with azoospermia more than 25 years ago.

ON THIS PAGE

- 1 **What is azoospermia?**
- 2 **The two main types**
- 3 **How it is diagnosed**
- 4 **Treatment options**
- 5 **You are not alone**
- 6 **Sources**

Ask the community

Men who have had this diagnosis talk about it every week on the forum.

Ask a question

In short

- ✓ Azoospermia means there is no measurable sperm in the ejaculate.
- ✓ It affects about 1% of all men and around 10–15% of men with infertility.
- ✓ There are two main types, obstructive and non-obstructive, and they are treated differently.
- ✓ Many men still have options, including sperm retrieval with ICSI or donor sperm. A urologist or andrologist can talk them through with you.

What is azoospermia?

Azoospermia means there is no measurable sperm in the ejaculate. It affects about 1% of all men and around 10–15% of men with infertility.

It is usually confirmed by at least two semen analyses, with the sample spun down (centrifuged) so the lab can look carefully for any sperm at all.

The two main types

BLOCKAGE

Obstructive

Sperm are made, but a blockage stops them reaching the ejaculate. This can happen:

- after a vasectomy
- after infection or injury
- with congenital absence of the vas deferens, which is linked to cystic fibrosis gene changes

PRODUCTION

Non-obstructive

The testes make very little or no sperm. Causes include:

- genetic conditions such as Klinefelter syndrome or Y-chromosome microdeletions
- hormone problems
- a history of undescended testes
- previous chemotherapy or radiotherapy

How it is diagnosed

Working out which type you have shapes every next step. Your doctor may arrange:

✓ **Repeat semen analysis**

To confirm the result on a second sample.

✓ **Physical examination**

Of the testes and the tubes that carry sperm.

✓ **Hormone blood tests**

FSH, LH and testosterone.

✓ **Genetic tests**

Karyotype, Y-chromosome microdeletion and CFTR.

✓ **Scrotal ultrasound**

Sometimes, to look at the testes and surrounding structures.

Treatment options

If it is obstructive

Surgical repair, such as a vasectomy reversal, or sperm retrieval (PESA, MESA or TESA) with the sperm then used in ICSI.

If it is non-obstructive

In some men, hormone treatment. Surgical sperm retrieval, such as micro-TESE, with any sperm found used in ICSI.

Donor sperm

Donor sperm is another route to parenthood, and one many couples on the forum have talked through openly.

 **Talk your options through with a specialist.** A urologist or andrologist can explain which routes fit your results.

FROM THE FORUM

You are not alone

Men with azoospermia, and their partners, talk about tests, retrieval and what comes next on the Causes of male infertility board. [n] members are discussing it.

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

Obstructive after vasectomy: PESA or reversal?

Karyotype normal, still waiting on Y-microdeletion results

Visit the board

Free to read. Post under any username.

Sources

- 1. [Source 1 — e.g. NHS / NICE / WHO guidance]
- 2. [Source 2 — e.g. professional society guideline on male infertility]
- 3. [Source 3 — e.g. peer-reviewed review article]

 Mensfe is peer support. It does not replace personal professional, legal or medical advice. Please talk to your own doctor about your results.

Was this page helpful?

 **Yes**

 **No**

Ask the community

Still have questions? Men who have been there will answer.

Start a topic

 **mensfe**

Information, help and support for male infertility and fertility issues, by you, for you. You'll never walk alone at Mensfe.

Founded by Pip Reilly and Rob Barlow. Member of iCSI, International Consumer Support for Infertility.

info@mensfe.net

Forum

[All boards](#)
[Research board](#)
[Forum rules](#)
[Sign in](#)
[Join free](#)

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[Male fertility](#)
[Azoospermia](#)
[Treatment](#)
[Medical: jargon explained](#)
[Emotive: emotional issues](#)

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